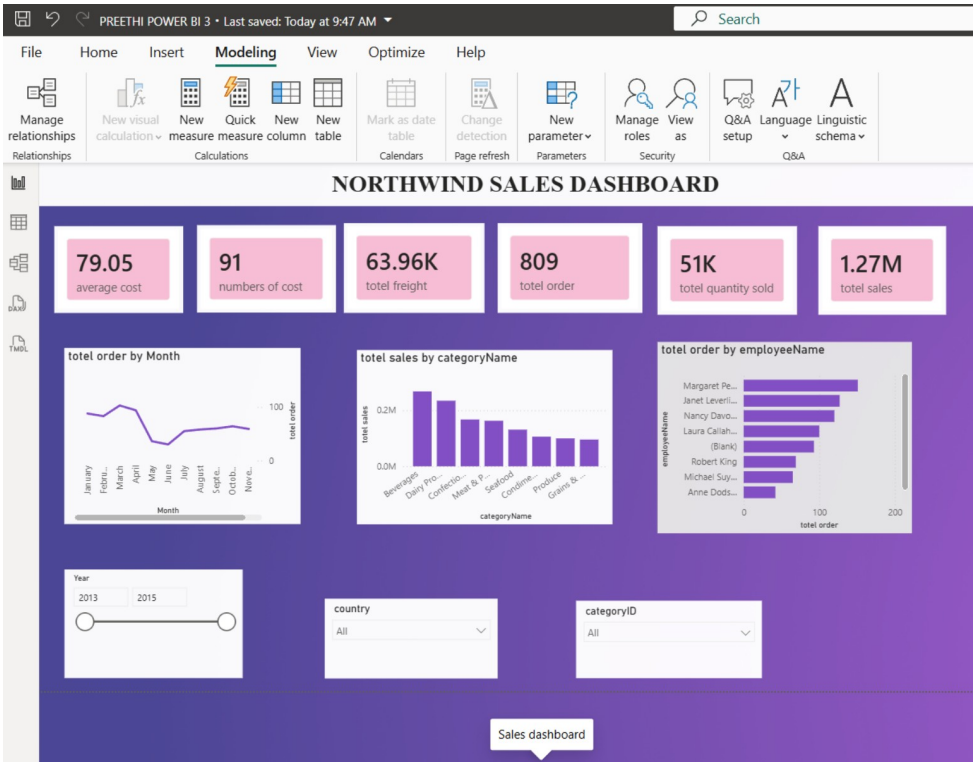
BUSINESS INSIGHT REPORT

NORTHWIND SALES DASHBOARD

Sales, Orders, Freight, Category and Country Performance Analysis



Prepared by	Course / Module	Report basis
Keerthana	B.Com FinTech with AI	Northwind Sales Dashboard screenshots

This report interprets the visible dashboard KPIs, charts, filters and product table. Where the screenshot does not show exact chart values, the analysis uses relative comparisons rather than inventing figures.

1. Executive Summary

The Northwind Sales Dashboard brings together headline cost and sales indicators with visual breakdowns by month, product category, employee and country. The KPI cards show an average cost of 79.05, 91 cost records, total freight of 63.96K, 809 orders, approximately 51K units sold and total sales of 1.27M.

The charts suggest that order volume changes during the year, sales are not evenly distributed across categories, and employee order counts vary. The country chart also shows differences in the number of cost records. These views can help management identify areas for follow-up, but the screenshot alone does not provide every underlying figure or confirm the causes of the differences.

Headline dashboard indicators

KPI shown	Displayed value	What it helps monitor
Average cost	79.05	Typical cost level across the records included in the current view.
Number of cost	91	Count of cost records or distinct cost entries represented by the dashboard measure.
Total freight	63.96K	Aggregate freight cost or freight measure; currency is not visible in the screenshot.
Total order	809	Overall order volume.
Total quantity sold	51K	Total units/quantity sold, approximately.
Total sales	1.27M	Overall sales value, approximately.

Important note: the dashboard labels contain spelling variations such as “totel” and “numbers of cost”. This report uses clearer wording while preserving the values shown in the screenshots.

2. Dashboard Overview

The dashboard is designed as a compact management view. The first screen displays six KPI cards and three charts: total orders by month, total orders by employee name, and total sales by category. The later dashboard view adds a country-level cost chart and a detailed product table with sales and quantity sold.

Main dashboard components

Component	Purpose
KPI cards	Provide a quick summary of cost, freight, orders, quantity sold and sales.
Total order by Month	Shows how order volume changes across the months.
Total sales by categoryName	Compares sales contribution across product categories.
Total order by employeeName	Ranks employees by order count in the displayed view.
Numbers of cost by country	Compares the count of cost records by country.
Product table	Lists product name, category, total sales and total quantity sold.
Year slider	Allows the report to be viewed across a selected year range; the screenshot shows 2013–2015.
Country and categoryID filters	Allow users to narrow the displayed information by country or category ID.

Dashboard screenshot – overview

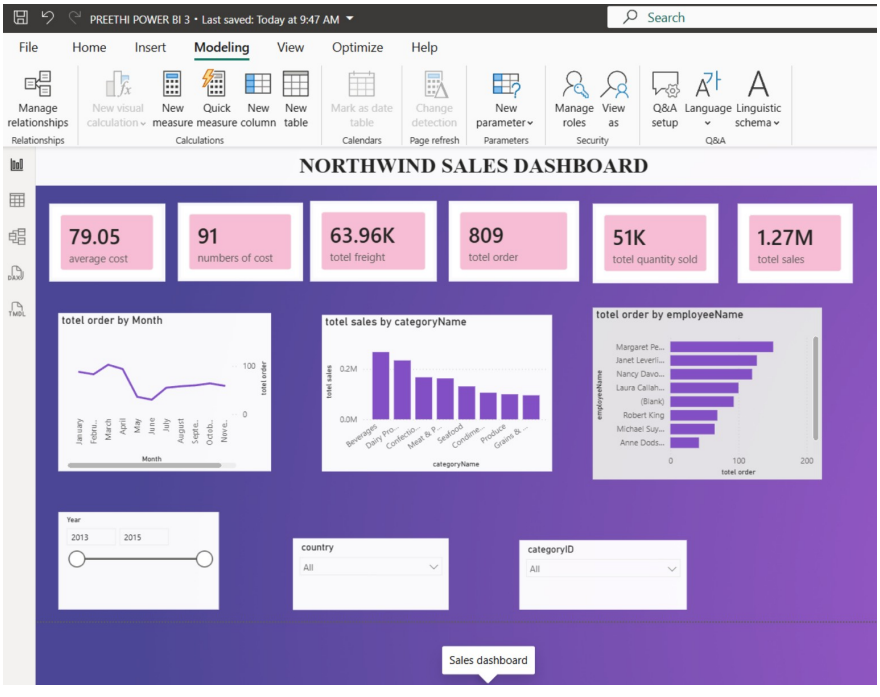


Figure 1. Northwind Sales Dashboard overview with KPI cards, monthly orders, category sales, employee orders and filters.

3. Order Trends by Month

The line chart titled “total order by Month” shows order counts changing over the months. The line starts at a relatively high level, rises around March, then falls sharply around May and June. It subsequently recovers and remains comparatively steady through the later months shown.

Business interpretation

The mid-year drop is the most visible movement in the chart. It should be investigated before changing stock or staffing plans. Possible explanations to check include seasonal demand, availability, promotional timing or changes in the selected date range; the screenshot itself does not establish which explanation applies.

Recommended action

Compare monthly orders with sales, stock availability and promotion calendars. Use a chronological month order and compare multiple years separately to determine whether the dip repeats consistently or is specific to the selected period.

4. Sales by Product Category

The category column chart shows that Beverage is the highest-selling category in the displayed view, followed by Dairy Products and Confections. Meat and Seafood sit in the middle of the visible ranking, while Condiments, Produce and Grains & Cereals appear lower. The chart indicates a difference in sales contribution between categories, although exact values are not labelled for every bar.

Business interpretation

The stronger categories may be important contributors to total revenue, while lower-ranked categories may need a closer review. However, lower sales alone do not prove weak profitability: category margin, price, inventory and quantity sold should be considered together.

Recommended action

Review sales and profit by category side by side. Maintain product availability in leading categories and investigate whether lower-ranked categories need assortment changes, better visibility or targeted promotions. Avoid reducing a category based on sales rank alone.

5. Order Count by Employee

The horizontal bar chart ranks employees by total order count. Margaret Pe... has the longest visible bar, followed by Janet Leverli..., Nancy Davo... and Laura Callah.... The chart also includes a blank employee-name category, followed by Robert King, Michael Suy... and Anne Dodds.... Names are truncated by the visual, so the full names should be checked in the Power BI report.

Business interpretation

Order count is a useful activity measure, but it does not by itself measure employee performance or profitability. Employees may handle orders of different sizes or product mixes. The blank category also suggests that some records may not have an employee name assigned.

Recommended action

Check the complete employee names and investigate the blank category. Compare order count with total sales, average order value, profit and customer service indicators before drawing conclusions about performance. Where appropriate, share effective practices across the team.

6. Number of Cost Records by Country

The country chart compares the number of cost records by country. France appears at the top of the visible ranking, with Germany and Brazil also among the higher bars. The UK follows, while Mexico, Spain and Venezuela are in the middle. Several countries, including Ireland, Norway and Poland, have shorter bars in the displayed view.

Business interpretation

The chart describes the count of cost records, not the total cost amount. A country with more records may simply have more transactions, rather than higher spending or worse cost efficiency. For cost management, the count should be paired with total cost, average cost, order volume and sales.

Recommended action

Compare both cost-record counts and cost values by country. Investigate countries with high total costs or unusually high average costs, and verify that all country names and cost entries are consistently recorded.

Screenshot – country and product detail

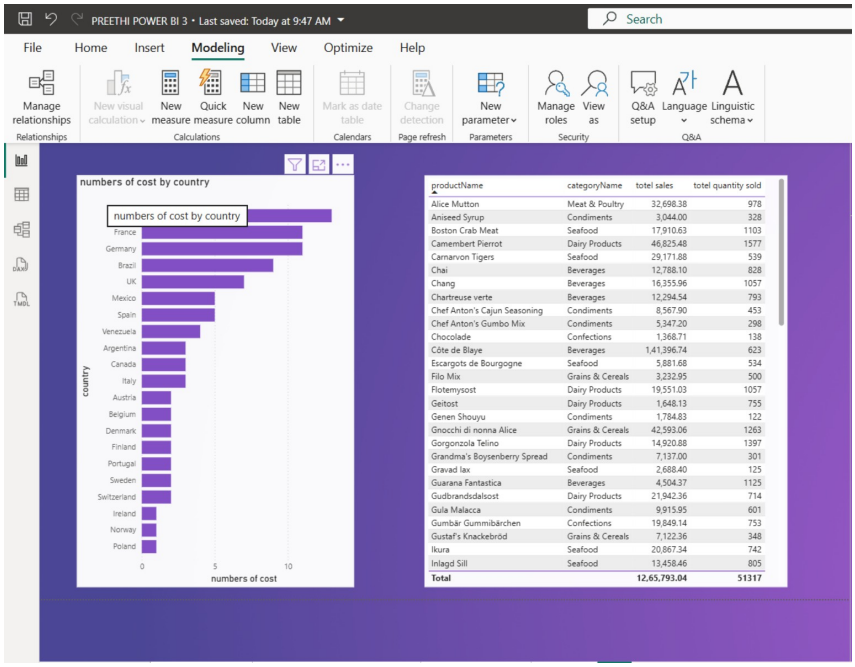


Figure 2. Country cost-record count and product-level sales/quantity table shown in the supplied screenshot.

7. Product-Level Sales and Quantity Analysis

The product table displays ProductName, categoryName, total sales and total quantity sold. It provides a more detailed view than the category chart and allows users to compare individual products within the same category. The visible rows include products such as Alice Mutton, Aniseed Syrup, Boston Crab Meat, Camembert Pierrot, Chai and Chang.

Examples visible in the table

Product	Category	Total sales shown	Total quantity sold shown
Alice Mutton	Meat & Poultry	32,698.38	978
Aniseed Syrup	Condiments	3,044.00	328
Boston Crab Meat	Seafood	17,910.63	1,103
Camembert Pierrot	Dairy Products	46,825.48	1,577
Carnavon Tigers	Seafood	29,171.88	539
Chai	Beverages	12,788.10	828
Chang	Beverages	16,355.96	1,057
Chartreuse verte	Beverages	12,294.54	793
Côte de Blaye	Beverages	1,413,967.74	623
Gnocchi di nonna Alice	Grains & Cereals	42,593.06	1,263

The screenshot’s total row displays total sales of 12,657,793.04 and total quantity sold of 51,317. This table total does not match the KPI card’s rounded total sales of 1.27M, so the displayed table and KPI may be using different filters, fields or aggregation settings. The report does not assume these totals are directly comparable without checking the Power BI model.

Recommended action

Sort the product table by total sales and quantity sold, then compare high-sales products with their profit or cost values if those measures are available. Check filter context and measure definitions whenever the product-table grand total differs from a KPI card.

8. KPI Interpretation and Business Insights

The six headline measures summarise activity and scale, but each should be interpreted in context.

Measure	Observation	Management use
Average cost: 79.05	An average cost value is shown; its currency and exact calculation are not visible.	Confirm the measure definition and compare across periods, countries and categories.
Number of cost: 91	The dashboard reports 91.	Check whether this represents distinct cost entries, records or another count measure.
Total freight: 63.96K	Freight is displayed in abbreviated form.	Track freight alongside order volume and sales to understand delivery-cost movement.
Total order: 809	The dashboard reports 809 orders.	Monitor demand and compare order volume by month and employee.
Total quantity sold: 51K	The KPI is rounded; the table total shows 51,317.	Use the detailed table for precise quantity checks and validate filter context.
Total sales: 1.27M	The KPI is rounded; the table total shows 12,657,793.04.	Validate the underlying measure, active filters and formatting before reporting a final sales total.

Key insight 1 – Category sales are uneven. Beverage and Dairy Products lead the visible category chart, so their contribution deserves regular monitoring.

Key insight 2 – Order volume varies by month. The sharp mid-year decline should be compared against previous years and operational data before making planning decisions.

Key insight 3 – Employee order counts differ. Use order count as an activity indicator, not as a complete performance score.

Key insight 4 – Country cost counts need context. A higher number of cost records is not the same as a higher total cost.

Key insight 5 – Dashboard totals should be reconciled. The KPI total sales value and product-table total appear inconsistent in the screenshots, so measure and filter definitions should be verified.

9. Business Recommendations

1. Validate KPI definitions. Confirm the calculation, unit and currency for average cost, number of cost and total freight before presenting them as formal business results.

2. Reconcile total sales. Review filters, relationships, data types and DAX measures to understand why the 1.27M KPI differs from the product table's displayed total of 12,657,793.04.

3. Improve monthly planning. Investigate the visible mid-year fall in orders and compare the same months across the selected years before changing inventory or staffing levels.

4. Review category performance using more than sales. Pair sales with quantity sold, cost and profit to identify categories that generate sustainable value.

5. Use balanced employee measures. Compare employee order counts with sales value, average order size, profit and service quality; check and resolve blank employee names.

6. Analyse country costs in context. Compare cost counts with total cost, average cost, order volume and sales so that management can distinguish transaction volume from cost efficiency.

7. Use filters consistently. Record the selected year range, country and category ID whenever screenshots or totals are shared, so that comparisons use the same filter context.

10. Conclusion

The Northwind Sales Dashboard provides a practical overview of sales activity, order volume, freight, cost records and product performance. Its visualisations make it easier to spot differences across months, categories, employees and countries. In the screenshots, Beverage leads category sales, order volume falls around the middle of the year, employee order counts vary, and France is the highest country by visible cost-record count.

The most important next step is to validate the measures and filter context—especially the difference between the sales KPI and the product table total—before using the dashboard for final financial reporting. Once these checks are complete, the dashboard can support better monthly planning, category management and performance review.

Prepared by: Keerthana

Source: User-provided screenshots of the Northwind Sales Dashboard. Interpretations are limited to visible labels, values and chart patterns; exact values not shown in the screenshots have not been estimated.